

— AI Readiness Report | Midpoint Readout

Where AGA Stands, Where It Is Headed, and How It Gets There

Presented to the AGA AI Task Force | September 30, 2026

Prepared by OptimaNova AI



OPTIMANOVA
— AI —

AGA Has Moved From Exploring to Structured Since July

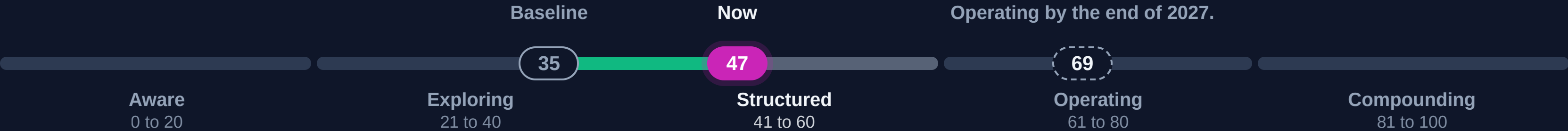
Overall Readiness Score

47 out of 100

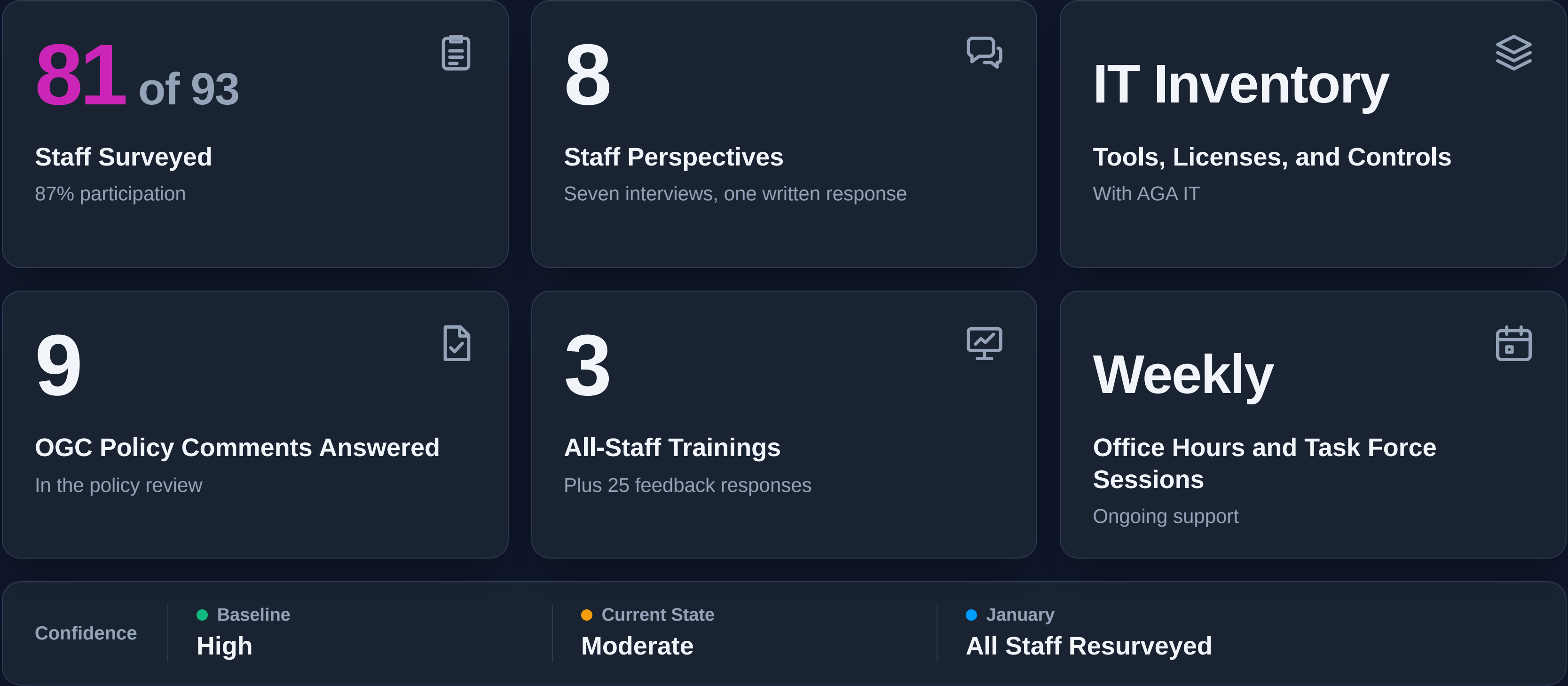
● Tier Structured

- Ahead of most organizations on policy, training, and access to a sanctioned tool.
- The next exposure is data: Copilot now reaches every file a person can open.
- The next value is workflows with named owners and measured results.

Six Decisions Today →



Six Sources Stand Behind Every Finding



Adoption Arrived Before the Rules Did



Survey of 81 of 93 staff, July 29 to August 6, 2026.

— Progress Since Baseline

Sixty Days Rebuilt the Foundations

Before

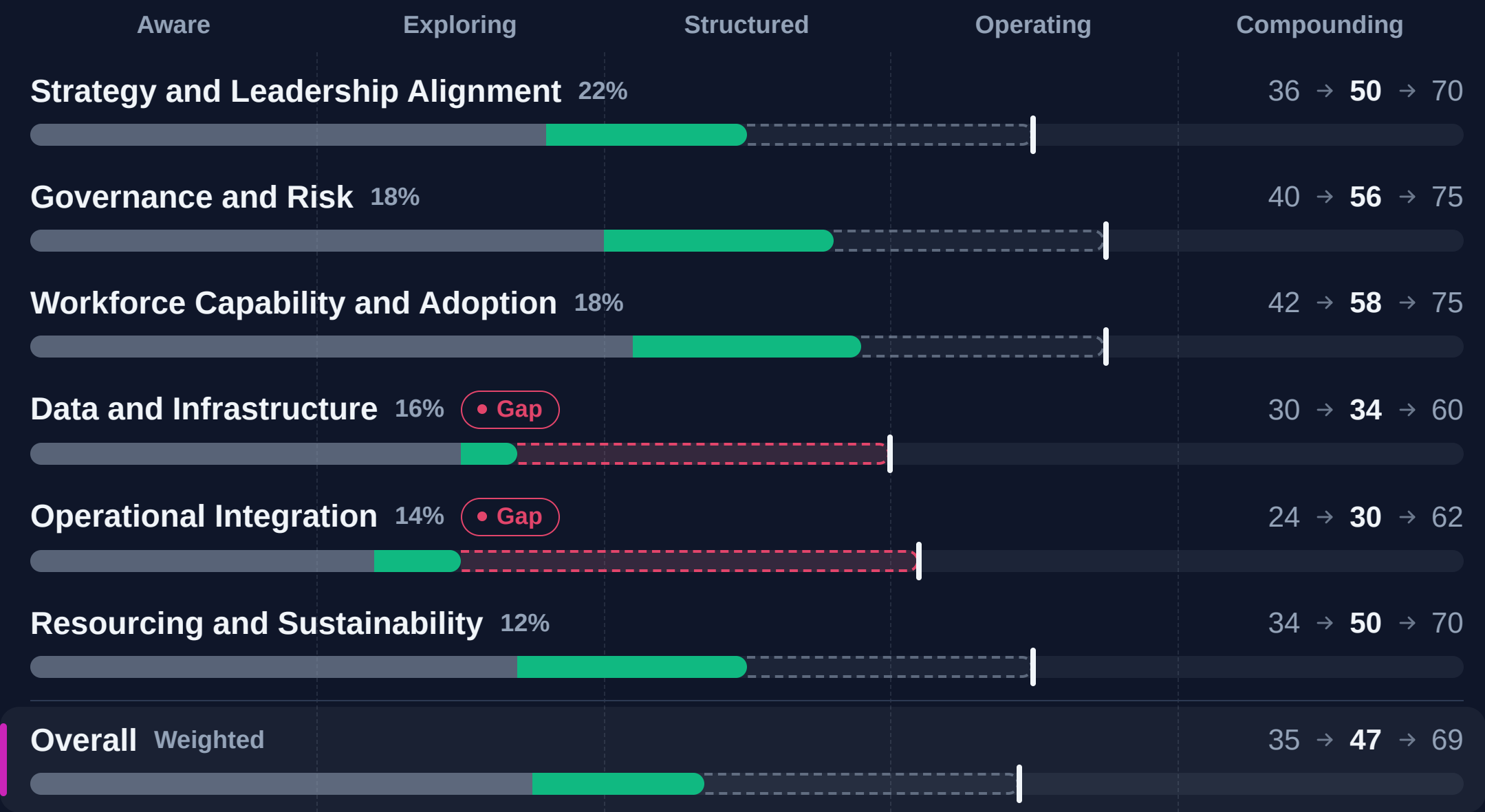
After

	Before	After	
AI Policy	On paper; approved list out of step with licenses	In effect and taught in mandatory all-staff training, with the traffic light	In Effect
Training	None	Three all-staff sessions, participation near 100%	
Upgraded Copilot	21 of 93 staff (23%)	Every staff member (100%)	
Confidence 4 or 5 (Feedback Respondents)	24%	76%	
Copilot on Real Work Since Training	None measured	18 of 25 respondents	
Agent Governance	None	Section 10A and a register, ready to adopt	Ready to Adopt
Staff Support	None	Weekly office hours	Weekly

Confidence figures come from 25 post-training responses with a recalled "before" rating; January resurveys all staff.

- ✓ Jennifer O'Shea pushed early for enterprise access. As of September 24, every staff member has it.

Four Dimensions Moved, and Two Are the Work Ahead



Evidence Panel

Overall Readiness

Baseline

35

Exploring

Now

47

Structured

2027 Target

69

Operating

- Baseline Level
- Movement Since Baseline
- Distance to 2027 Target
- Gap Marks the Work Ahead

Finding 1

AGA Is Ahead of Most Organizations on the Foundations



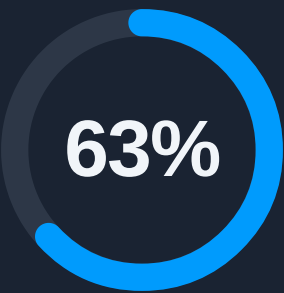
Bottom Line AGA's shadow AI at baseline was the norm: **78%** of AI users bring their own tools (Microsoft and LinkedIn, 2024). AGA now gives that work a sanctioned home.

Copilot Now Reaches Everyone, Which Makes Permissions the Next Exposure

- 01 Copilot can surface **any file a user can already open.**
- 02 AGA runs Microsoft 365 E3, without the Purview tier that auto-labels sensitive files.
- 03 Copilot prompts already sit in each user's mailbox, searchable in eDiscovery, under AGA's existing records schedule. OGC's rule holds: **every prompt is discoverable.**
- 04 No permissions review has run yet.

“
Use of Copilot enabled some participants to access documents that they should not have had permission to access.

Australian Government Copilot trial, 2024



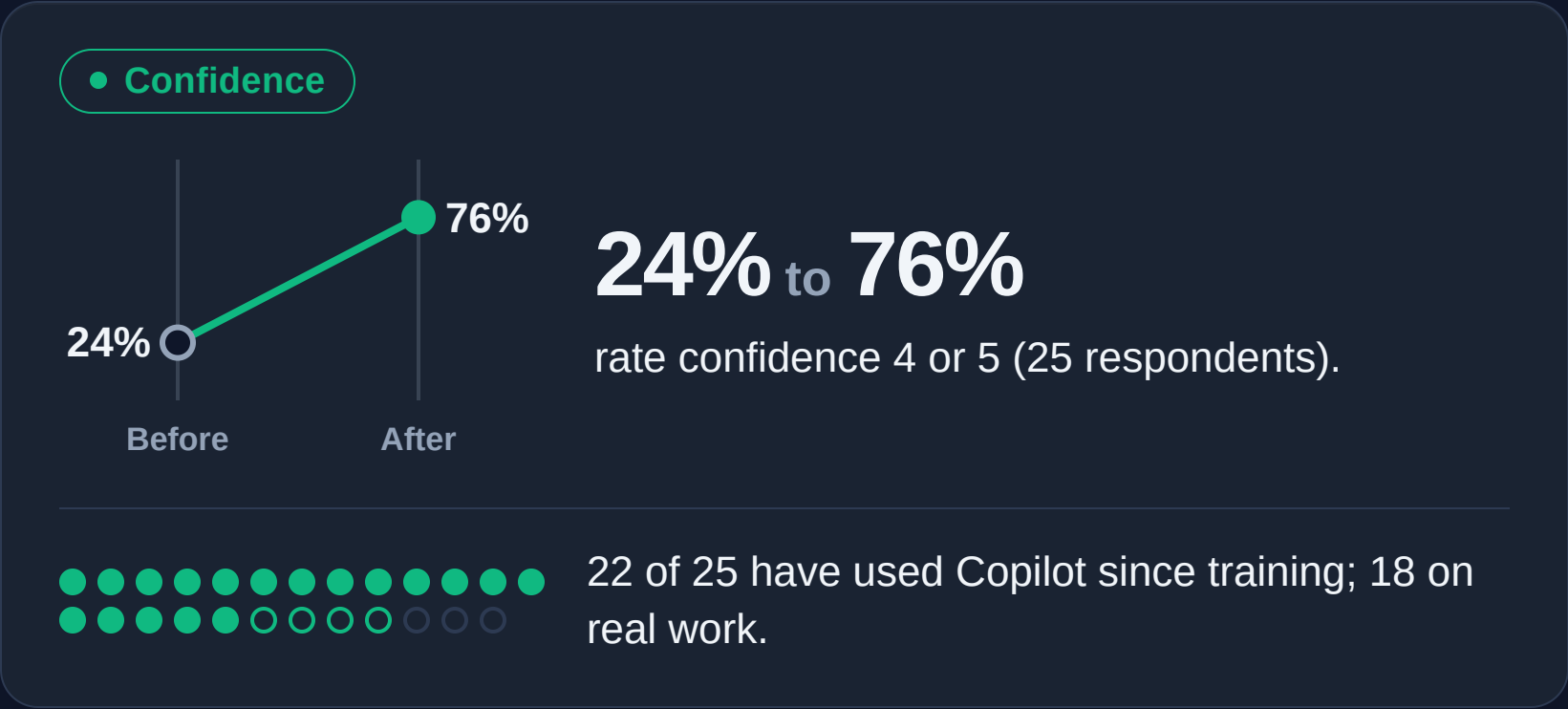
• Benchmark

of organizations lack or are unsure of AI-ready data practices

Gartner, 2025

→ **Next Move** Commission the permissions review, and restrict Copilot's reach into HR, finance, membership, board, and OGC sites now.

Confidence Is Rising, and Support Moves to Where Staff Work



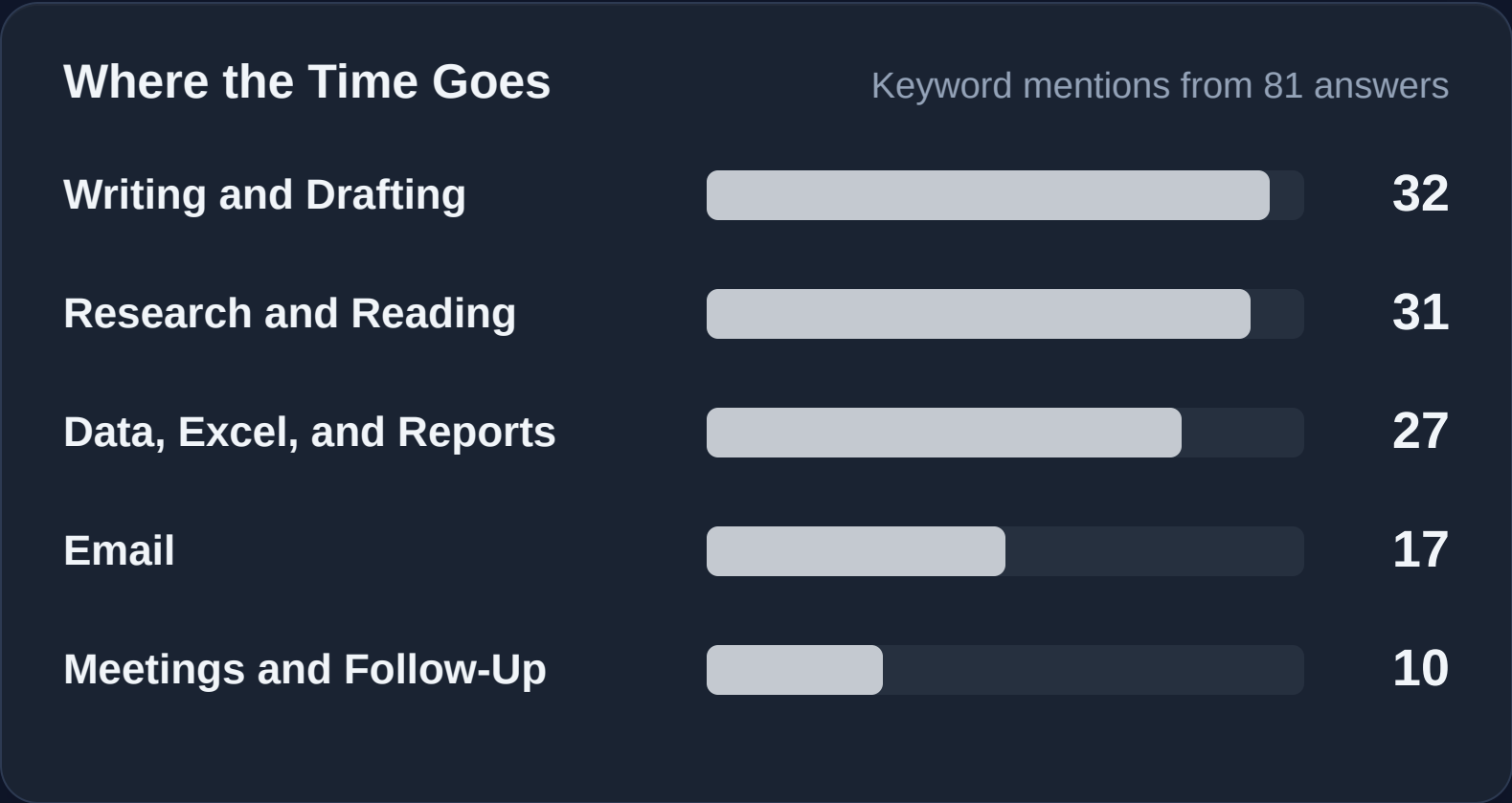
- Support
- Office hours drew little attendance, and the first post-training session had none.
 - Staff asked for tiered, role-based help and clarity on what data is allowed.

75% of staff with three or more forms of training were confident, 28 points higher than those with one.
Australian Government Copilot trial, 2024

AGA's CFO proposed departmental visits. Jeff Martin put it plainly:
“Bring it to them.”

→ **Next Move** Rotate the Thursday hour through departmental meetings, name ten champions, and launch an Ask Copilot inbox.

Value Lives in Workflows, and Workflows Run on Data



Evidence

Benchmark

Copilot saved **19 minutes a day** against a comparison group.
UK Department for Work and Pensions, 2026

Another UK department found **no evidence** that time saved became productivity.
Department for Business and Trade, 2025

37% of organizations attribute any earnings impact to AI.
McKinsey, 2026



AGA's Biggest Idea on Record

Member intelligence, where members ask questions of AGA data in plain language. It starts with AI-ready data.

→ Next Move

Three proof workflows with named owners and before-and-after measures.

The Governance Framework Is Sound, and Five Decisions Complete It

01

Policy v1.2

Split approved tools into licensed and evaluated, append the traffic light, add the no-fault path for mistakes, tie acknowledgment to training.

02

Member-Data Rule

De-identified member data is yellow; identifiable member survey data stays red until AGA tells members up front that survey data may be analyzed with AI inside AGA's secure environment.

03

Agent Registration

Adopt Section 10A so every agent has an owner and a register entry before it runs.

04

Tool Intake

A one-page request, triage by traffic light, and a decision in ten business days. The event-planning platform request is the first case.

05

Executive Owner

One accountable leader for AI, with the Task Force chartered for decisions.

• Red Lines

• Green Environment

Built on Michael Murray's red lines and Jim Steffes's “green environment” framing.

— Target State

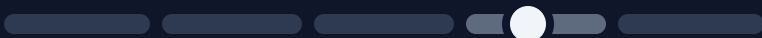
Where AGA Should Be by the End of 2027: Operating

Overall Target, End of 2027

69

out of 100

● Tier Operating



Strategy

70

A stated AI direction from leadership, one accountable owner, FY27 objectives with measures.

Governance

75

v1.2 enforced, every agent registered, tool decisions in ten business days, annual NIST review.

Workforce

75

Champions in every department; most staff confident and using sanctioned AI weekly.

Data

60

Sensitive sites locked down for Copilot; member data described and governed.

Integration

62

Five or more workflows with owners and measured results; first agents in production.

Resourcing

70

An FY27 AI budget line; licenses justified by usage evidence.

The Road From Here, and How OptimaNova Gets AGA There

Phase 1 Contracted, Through Late January

Phase 2

● Today

October

Next 30 Days

- Decisions made
- Champions named
- Departmental rotation begins
- First pulse survey
- Proof workflows selected
- Tool intake live
- Permissions review scoped

November to January

Phase 1 Close

- Policy v1.2 issued and acknowledged
- Build support with shadowing on three workflows
- AI corner design to IT for build
- November and December pulse surveys
- FIMS model described and Power BI test (AGA data team)
- January follow-up survey
- Train-the-trainer handoff
- Success metrics dashboard
- Close-Out Edition and leadership readout

FY27

Phase 2 and AGA Initiatives

- Permissions remediation and data security
- Member data foundation and intelligence design
- Agent program
- Role-based learning tracks
- Annual policy review
- AGA as the industry's resource on responsible AI

① Licensing costs are separate from consulting fees.

In January, We Measure Behavior and Outcomes

Measure	Baseline		January Target
Weekly Use of AGA-Sanctioned AI	67% Any AI Weekly		75% Sanctioned
AI Use Outside AGA's Microsoft Tools	65% Used ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini		Under 20%
Confidence 4 or 5	36%		60%
Unsure What Is Allowed	38%		Under 15%
Proof Workflows With Measured Results	0		3
Departments Reached by Embedded Support	0		All

Measured by the January follow-up survey (baseline items plus OptimaNova's 12-item core) and Microsoft 365 usage reports, timed to feed AGA's January utilization review.

Six Decisions Move AGA Forward

0 of 6
Decided

Decision	Owner	By
☐ 1 Name the executive owner for AI and charter the Task Force	Karen Harbert, Jim Steffes	October 31
☐ 2 Approve the support shift: departmental rotation, champions, Ask Copilot	AI Task Force, Melissa Lisher	October 7
☐ 3 Choose three proof workflows and their owners	AI Task Force	October 15
☐ 4 Decide the member-data rule for AI inside the tenant	AI Task Force with OGC	October 31
☐ 5 Commission the Copilot permissions review (Phase 2)	Jim Steffes; Jeff Martin with OptimaNova	October 31
☐ 6 Set the FY27 AI budget line and open Phase 2 scoping	Jim Steffes, CFO, Karen Harbert	Before FY27 budget close

Staff said yes to AI in August. Between now and January, we point that energy at the work that matters most.

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Methodology and Confidence

The Model: OptimaNova v2.0

Six weighted dimensions, each scored 0 to 100 against evidence rubrics.



Aware 0 to 20 **Exploring** 21 to 40 **Structured** 41 to 60 **Operating** 61 to 80 **Compounding** 81 to 100

Crosswalk to the Six Dimensions Named in August

Strategy and Leadership Alignment

August: Leadership and Strategy

Governance and Risk

August: Governance and Ethics

Workforce Capability and Adoption

August: Workforce and Training

Data and Infrastructure

August: Data Infrastructure; Technology and Tools

Operational Integration

August: Job Design and Workflows

Resourcing and Sustainability

Added in OptimaNova's August model update

Six Sources

Readiness Survey	81 of 93 staff (87%), July 29 to August 6, 2026
Staff Perspectives	Seven interviews, one written response
IT Inventory	Tools, licenses, and controls, with AGA IT
Policy Review	Nine OGC comments answered
Training	Three all-staff sessions, 25 feedback responses
Ongoing Support	Weekly office hours and Task Force sessions

Confidence

● Baseline: High	Near-census survey (margin of error about plus or minus 4 points), eight staff perspectives, IT inventory.
● Current: Moderate	Documented actions plus 25 feedback responses; all staff resurveyed in January.
● Targets	OptimaNova's recommendation.
● Comparisons	Published research only.

Benchmark Sources

Gallup

July 20, 2026; n = 22,573

30% of U.S. employees use AI a few times a week or more.

Slide 7

ISACA AI Pulse Poll

May 2026; 3,400+ professionals

38% of organizations have a formal, comprehensive AI policy; 33% train all employees.

Slide 7

KPMG US

April 2025; n = 1,019

Half of U.S. workers use AI without knowing whether it is allowed.

Slide 7

NTEN and Bridgespan

September 2026; nonprofit executives, n = 404

42% report a named owner or group for AI oversight.

Slide 7

Microsoft and LinkedIn Work Trend Index

May 2024; n = 31,000

78% of AI users bring their own AI tools to work.

Slide 7

Australia Digital Transformation Agency, Copilot Trial

October 2024

Some participants could access documents they should not have had permission to access; 75% of staff with three or more forms of training were confident, 28 points higher than those with one.

Slides 8 and 9

Gartner

February 2025; n = 1,203

63% of organizations lack or are unsure they have AI-ready data practices.

Slide 8

Microsoft Learn, Purview

Product documentation

Copilot prompts and responses are stored in the user's mailbox and searchable by eDiscovery tools.

Slide 8

UK Department for Work and Pensions

January 2026

Copilot saved 19 minutes a day against a comparison group.

Slide 10

UK Department for Business and Trade

August 2025

Did not find evidence that time savings have led to improved productivity.

Slide 10

McKinsey, The State of AI in 2026

August 2026; n = 1,719

37% attribute any EBIT impact to AI.

Slide 10